FW ICP: Ideal Customer Profile and Segments 2025+

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Vendor-facing reference for how Future Works qualifies accounts, sizes deals, and maps the buying committee. Use it to align outbound lists, brief SDRs, and pre-qualify referrals before you hand them across.

> Aligned to ICP and Positioning Lock v1.0 (R11), locked and approved. Decisions logged 26 August 2026. Updated 27 October 2026.

Future Works delivers outcome-based AI transformation in twelve-week cycles, run by named senior experts orchestrating fleets of AI agents, with each cycle paid on the outcome it delivers, measured against a baseline the client's Finance team approves. The ICP flows from that model: large and mid-market companies running large-scale physical operations, with a real P&L problem AI can move and an executive willing to sign for the outcome. No startups.

Language note for vendors. Do not use the phrase "asset-heavy" in outbound copy. It reads as heavy industry and causes good-fit companies to rule themselves out. Describe the value we drive and the operations we rebuild instead. "Asset-heavy" remains an internal scoring concept only.

Fit at a Glance

Attribute	Fit
Company size	Core: 501+ employees with revenue confirming scale, roughly $250M and above. Sweet spot $1B to $20B.
Geography	United States primary. Canada in full scope. European-only accounts are disqualified.
Business profile	Large-scale physical operations. Complex supply chains, physical assets, regulated workflows, or an operations-heavy P&L.

Buying trigger	A named P&L problem AI can move, or an AI program that stalled in pilot.
Commercial appetite	Willing to sign an outcome-based SOW where each cycle is paid on the outcome it delivers, measured against a baseline Finance approves.
Existing spend	Active or expiring engagement with a Tier 1 or Tier 2 systems integrator (Accenture, Wipro, TCS, Infosys, Deloitte, EY, Capgemini).
Deal size	Cycle 1 around $400K. Cycle 2 around $650K. Multi-cycle programs land in the low millions.

Size Bands

Employee count is the lead filter because it is the reliable one. Revenue confirms scale. Qualification itself runs on the value-primary gate, so these bands build the funnel rather than close it.

Band	Definition	How to route
Core	501+ employees, revenue roughly $250M and above	Standard motion. Route in.
Edge	201 to 500 employees, or revenue $100M to $250M	Inbound only. Never source through outbound. An inbound Edge account enters only with a quantified value line, as a Future Works decision, not standard pipeline.
Out	Below 200 employees, or below $100M revenue	Do not route through outbound. No exceptions.

Below roughly 500 employees the buyer stack thins and the value math gets hard at our cycle pricing, which is why the Edge band carries a value-line requirement.

Geography Rules

- **United States.** Primary market.
- **Canada.** Full scope, not selective. Calgary is an active hub.
- **Parent-entity rule.** A non-US headquarters with US operations qualifies at parent level. Philips and Sun Life are the pattern.
- **Mexican operations of US and global parents** are in scope through the parent rule. This is how we capture the nearshoring wave. Mexico is not a target headquarters country in its own right.
- **European-only accounts are disqualified.** This is a standing rule and it is the most common routing error. If the account has no US or Canadian entity, do not route it.

Company Profile

Attribute	Detail
Segment mix	Roughly half enterprise, half large mid-market. Startups are out of scope.
Revenue	$250M and above. Sweet spot $1B to $20B.
Employee count	501 and above.
Geography	United States primary, Canada full. See the geography rules above.
Operating profile	Companies that make, move, power, grow, build, or heal something physical, plus the high-tech and real-estate segments that run on the same operational spine.
Tech estate	Established ERP, TMS, WMS, PLM, or MES footprint. Legacy integration risk is real, not theoretical.
Current state	Running one or more transformation programs with an incumbent SI.

	Frequently in pilot purgatory on AI.
Trigger event	AI program failure forcing a reset. Incumbent SI contract at renewal. Board mandate on transformation ROI. New Chief AI Officer or new CFO in seat. Supply chain disruption event.

Qualified Lead Definition

A qualified lead has all six attributes below. Missing any one of them means the account moves to nurture, not pipeline.

Signal	What good looks like
Named buyer	CIO tier, CSCO, Chief AI Officer, Chief Innovation or Transformation Officer, or COO. Title reports directly to the CEO or one level below.
P&L problem	Buyer can name a specific operational number they want moved (margin points, freight cost, OTIF, working capital, cycle time, exception cost).
Executive sponsor	A C-level executive willing to sign for the outcome, not just approve the budget.
Operator champion	An internal logic owner, head of program, or senior director who will run day-to-day delivery with the Future Works pod.

Budget posture	Discretionary transformation budget already allocated, or a workstream being pulled from an incumbent SI's existing budget line.
Commercial fit	Willing to entertain an outcome-staked SOW with a CFO-validatable value methodology. PHL-1 is the precedent artifact.

What We Sell

Four capabilities. Vendors and partners should describe Future Works by the value we drive first, industry second.

Capability	The value it names	Anchor proof
AI Operationalization	AI strategy converted into a value-accounted use-case portfolio, with dollars per use case, visible to the CFO.	JLL (two-year AI roadmap unlocked in eight weeks).
Supply Chain and Fulfillment Transformation	Margin and working capital recovered from the physical flow of goods.	Global health technology company (Philips, keep anonymous). 2-6x return in 12 weeks, Finance-signed.
Agentic Workflow Execution	Core workflows (order-to-cash, procure-to-pay, S&OP, contracts, service operations) run by agents at throughput a team cannot match.	Staples (20 digital products in 12 weeks).
Operational Resilience and Working Capital	A named, quantified operating-cost line taken out, and working capital released.	Global energy equipment manufacturer (NextPower, keep anonymous). 75% faster time to market.

Two naming changes from earlier versions: "Enterprise AI Operationalization" is now "AI Operationalization" and "Agentic Execution of Enterprise Workflows" is now "Agentic Workflow Execution". Both dropped the word "enterprise" because it made smaller accounts rule themselves out, and the volume of smaller programs is what gives the business stability.

Customer Experience and Service Operations is no longer a headline capability. Agentic resolution, service-desk operations, and escalation management fold into Agentic Workflow Execution. Exception-cost reduction folds into Operational Resilience and Working Capital.

Industries

Supply chain is a capability, not an industry. The former "Industrial Supply Chain" grouping has retired into the Supply Chain and Fulfillment Transformation capability above.

Tier 1: source outbound here

These five are the outbound priority. If you are building lists, build them here.

1. **Manufacturing and Industrials.** Machinery, equipment makers, industrial automation, conglomerates.
2. **Energy.** Transition, grid, renewables, and power. Exclude upstream oil and gas extraction, where the capex cadence fights our twelve-week motion.
3. **Health and Life Sciences.** Lead with medical devices, health technology, and pharmaceutical manufacturing. De-emphasize providers and payers.
4. **Logistics and Transportation.** Trucking, rail, freight, warehousing, third-party logistics.
5. **Consumer Products.** Makers of goods, including food production and packaging.

Watch tier: inbound and opportunistic only

Real fit exists here and we will take inbound, but do not source outbound against these without checking first: Construction and Infrastructure, High Tech (semiconductors, electronics, hardware), Aerospace and Defense, Agriculture and Food, Automotive, Commercial Real Estate, Chemicals, Utilities, Retail.

Two boundary rules inside the watch tier:

- **Aerospace and Defense.** Outbound stays commercial aerospace. Defense is watchlist only, and defense inbound is handled case by case.
- **Commercial Real Estate.** Warm inbound only. We hold real proof here (JLL, Haystacks), but it is not an outbound target.

Distinctions that matter

- **Consumer Products versus Retail.** Consumer Products means makers of goods and is Tier 1. Retail means sellers of goods and is watch tier. Do not merge them.
- **Manufacturing.** Plain "manufacturing" is the door most buyers recognize. "Advanced manufacturing" is a keyword, never the label.

Out of Scope

Do not route these to Future Works. They will not convert and they distort our list quality.

- Companies below 200 employees or below $100M revenue, including startups and Series A through C.
- European-only accounts with no US or Canadian entity.
- Mexico as a target headquarters country. Mexican operations of US and global parents are fine through the parent rule.
- Metals and Mining, and upstream Oil and Gas extraction.
- Paper and Packaging as a standalone lens. It sits inside Manufacturing and Consumer Products.
- Standalone Defense for outbound.
- Private Equity as an industry target. Inbound only, by standing rule. Funds, investment banks, and asset managers are the same: take inbound if the workflow matches a capability, do not source outbound.
- Emerging-tech categories (Quantum, Web3, AR/VR, blockchain, gene therapy) as a primary industry lens.
- Pure staff augmentation, body-shop, or time-and-materials requests. Future Works does not sell hourly bench capacity.
- Pilot-for-pilot's-sake requests with no production path and no Finance-validated value target.
- Marketing function buyers. CMOs and marketing operations leaders are not in the buyer set.
- Accounts unwilling to let the CFO's office validate the baseline and the value methodology.

Buying Committee

Every enterprise deal at Future Works has a three-tier committee. Map the account to this structure before you brief the AE.

Tier 1: Primary Commercial Buyer (Gamora, Level 1)

The buyer of record. Owns the transformation budget and the relationship with the incumbent SI. One of these seats signs the SOW.

Persona	Title set	Signature P&L problem	What sells them
Gamora-CIO	CIO, CDO, CIDO, operational CTO, Chief Digital and Transformation Officer, Global Head of IT and Process Excellence	AI stuck in pilot, SI workstream underperforming, board narrative on transformation	Outcome-staked tranches, named senior experts, 12-week cycles, vendor-agnostic architecture
Gamora-COO	COO, EVP Operations, SVP Global Operations, SVP Operations	Operational KPIs missed, SI mobilization too slow, margin under pressure	12-week delivery cycle against operational KPIs, Service Credit safety net
Gamora-SC	Chief Supply Chain Officer, EVP or SVP Supply Chain	Margin, freight, OTIF, working capital, allocation logic	Outcome-staked terms tied to supply chain KPIs, PHL anchor case, agent-in-production proof
Gamora-AI	Chief AI Officer, Head of AI, VP of AI, Head of Data and AI	74% AI failure rate, pilot-to-production pressure, model trust	Agents in production (not demos), named AI engineers on contract, model performance staked in the SOW
Gamora-DX	Chief Innovation Officer, Chief Transformation Officer, Chief Digital and Transformation Officer, Head of Innovation, VP of Innovation	Innovation theatre fatigue, prove-it-fast pilots, board-ready proof	Sub-12-week phases, named experts, board-narrative-ready outcomes

Sequencing note: the Innovation or Transformation Officer is the cheapest front door, but commercial close usually moves to the CIO or CSCO. Do not treat Gamora-DX as the signatory unless the account confirms it.

Tier 2: Influencers Who Can Block (Star-Lord, Level 0)

At Future Works deal sizes, these seats do not sign the SOW. They approve it, or they quietly kill it.

Persona	Title set	What they need to hear
Star-Lord (CEO)	CEO, President, Managing Director, Executive Chair, Chairman of the Executive Board	Risk transfer to Future Works, not vendor gambling. Board-ready narrative. One-page brief, not a deck.

Star-Lord (CFO)	CFO, EVP Finance, SVP Finance	CFO-validatable value methodology locked in Week 2. Baseline signed by their Finance team. Overdrive Bonus mechanics survive audit.
Procurement	Category lead for professional services or transformation	The outcome-staked model is unusual but precedented. PHL-1 is the reference SOW. Expect three to eight weeks of procurement education.

Tier 3: Delivery Champions and Operators (Nebula and Groot, Levels 2 and 3)

These seats do not buy. They make delivery succeed or fail once the SOW is signed.

Persona	Title set	Role in the engagement
Nebula-Champion	Logic Owner, Head of Program, Senior Director of Operations, Director of IT, Director of Technology Innovation, SVP Operations Technology	Day-to-day partner for the Future Works pod. If they are bought in, the program ships. If they are skeptical, every workshop is a battle.
Groot-Operator	Supply Chain Planner, Production Planner, Logistics Planner, Operations Manager, Business Process Manager, Senior Supply Chain Manager	Uses the deployed agentic system daily. Change management for this layer matters more than any deck.

Buyer Demographics

Attribute	Detail
Age	40 to 65 for Tier 1 and Tier 2. 32 to 55 for Tier 3.
Education	Frequently MBA or advanced technical degree at Tier 1. Not material at Tier 3.

Income	$250K+ at Tier 1. $180K+ at Tier 2 (Nebula-Champion).
Tenure in seat	Two to seven years typical. New-in-seat (under 12 months) is a strong trigger.
Reports to	CEO (CIO, COO, CSCO, CFO). CIO or COO (Chief AI Officer, Chief Innovation Officer). Head of function (Nebula-Champion).
Location	United States and Canada. US metros overrepresented: New York, Boston, Chicago, Atlanta, Dallas, San Francisco, Seattle. Calgary is the active Canadian hub.

Trigger Signals

Score an account higher when you see two or more of these in a 90-day window.

- New CIO, Chief AI Officer, CSCO, or CFO in seat.
- Public AI program failure, write-off, or quiet reset.
- Incumbent SI contract renewal window (Accenture, Wipro, TCS, Infosys, Deloitte, EY, Capgemini).
- Board mandate on transformation ROI or AI operationalization.
- Supply chain disruption, allocation crisis, or S&OP cycle failure.
- Announced restructuring, spin-off, IPO prep, or activist pressure.
- Nearshoring or footprint reconfiguration into Mexico by a US or global parent.
- Named executive publishing on agentic AI, transformation ROI, or SI dissatisfaction.
- Post-conference activity from Gartner SCM Symposium, ASCM Connect, or CIO-tier summits.

How Vendors Should Route to Future Works

- If the account matches the fit table, sits in a Tier 1 industry, the buyer named the P&L problem, and there is an executive willing to sign for outcomes, route it in.

- If the account is under 200 employees or under $100M revenue, European-only, a time-and-materials staffing request, a marketing engagement, or a pilot with no production path, do not route it. Nurture or decline.
- If the account sits in the Edge band (201 to 500 employees, or $100M to $250M revenue), do not source it through outbound. If it comes in inbound, route it with the quantified value line stated up front. It will be reviewed as an exception.
- If the account is a good operational fit but the buyer is one level below the committee (director or below with no executive sponsor), route as an opportunity to open, not as a qualified deal.
- Include the trigger event, the incumbent SI, the named executive sponsor, and the operator champion in the intro. Missing any of these lengthens qualification.

Reference Anchors

- Philips (keep anonymous, see below). Industrial Supply Chain. 2-6x return in 12 weeks, Finance-signed, self-funded the next cycle.
- NextPower / Nextracker (keep anonymous, see below). 75% faster time to market. More than 20,000 work hours a year removed in the first cycle, and every cycle extended since.
- JLL. Two-year AI roadmap unlocked in eight weeks. Commercial Real Estate, warm inbound only.
- Staples. 20 digital products in 12 weeks.
- Boom Supersonic. Aerospace and Defense anchor, commercial aerospace.
- Trust posture: GDPR-compliant delivery, with SOC 2 Type II and ISO 27001 certification audits in progress and on schedule. Describe these as audits in progress, never as held certifications. Built on AWS, Azure, and Databricks.

Client names: keep Philips and NextPower anonymous. We prefer not to name either client in outbound, decks, landing pages, or any vendor-built material. Use the anonymous lines below instead.

- **Philips, full line:** "A global health technology company saw a 2-6x return in twelve weeks, signed off by its own Finance team, and funded the next cycle from the result."
- **Philips, short form:** "a global health technology company (2-6x return in twelve weeks, Finance-signed)"
- **NextPower, full line:** "At a global energy equipment manufacturer, the first twelve-week cycle took more than 20,000 work hours a year off the operation. The client has extended every cycle since, more than twelve so far."
- **NextPower, short form:** "a global energy equipment manufacturer (more than 20,000 work hours a year removed in cycle one)"

Keep figures out of the first cold email. Use these proof lines only where the sequence allows a proof line.